A Piece of String

Guy de Maupassant

Read the excerpt from 'A Piece of String, and answer the questions that follow:

SET I

The good old man choked with indignation and fear."How can anyone tell such lies to take away an honest man's reputation!"

There was no use in his protesting; nobody believed him. He was confronted with Malandain, who repeated and maintained his affirmation. At his own request Hauchecome was searched; nothing was found on him. Finally, the Mayor, very much perplexed, discharged him.

As he left the Mayor's office, the old man was surrounded and questioned by the villagers. He began to tell the story of the string. No one believed him. They laughed at him.

He went along, stopping his friends, showing his pockets turned inside out to prove that he had nothing. They said: "Old rascal, get out!"

The next day about one o'clock in the afternoon, an employee in a shop returned the pocketbook. The man claimed to have found the object in the road. Not knowing how to read, he had given it to his employer.

1) Why did the Mayor discharge Hauchecome?
2) The good old man choked with indignation and fear."How can anyone tell such lies to take away an honest man's reputation!". What characteristic of Hauchecome is revealed from the quote?

a) Proud b) Arrogance
c) Sense of self importance d) Honesty

3) How was the crowd outside reacted to Hauchecome?
4) Why did the Mayor search search Hauchecome?

a) because of suspicion b) He was in bad terms wit Hauchecome
c) The crowd wanted to search d) At his own request

5) Why did the person who found the pocketbook take it to his employer?
6) 'The old man was surrounded and questioned by the villagers.'
(Begin the sentence by using 'The villagers')

SET II

The peasant stood choking. He understood. They accused him of having the pocketbook returned by an accomplice. He tried to protest. All the table began to laugh. He could not finish his dinner and went away in the midst of jeers. He went home ashamed and indignant, choking with anger and confusion. His innocence was impossible to prove. And he was stricken to the heart by the injustice of the suspicion. Then he began to recount the adventure again, prolonging his history every day. Each time he added new reasons, more energetic protestations, more solemn oaths. "Those are lying excuses," they said behind his back. The people now made him talk about the string to amuse them. His mind, touched to the depth, began to weaken. Towards the end of December, he took to his bed. He died in the first days of January, and in the delirium of his death struggles he kept claiming his innocence, reiterating: "A piece of string, a piece of string, look – here it is, Your Honour, the Mayor."

1) What did the peasant understand from the tavern?
2) Why did Hauchecome go home ashamed and indignant?
3) 'Then he began to recount the adventure again, prolonging his history every day. Each time he added new reasons, more energetic protestations, more solemn oaths.'Which characteristic of Hauchecome is mentioned in these lines?

a) Anger b) Confusion
c) Indignant d) Obsession

4) How did Hauchecome try to claim his innocence in his deathbed?
5) Hauchecome died because of _____

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i) ashamed and indignant ii) social cruelty
iii) false accusation iv) energetic protestations

Choose the correct option

A) i,ii,iii are correct
B) ii is crrect
C) ii and iii are correct
D) I and iv are correct

6) Find out the noun phrase in subject position and verb phrase from the following sentence:
His innocence was impossible to prove.

ANSWERS

SET I

1) Hauchecome was searched, but nothing was found on him.
2) c)Sense of self importance
3) The old man was surrounded and questioned by the villagers. He began to tell the story of the string. No one believed him. They laughed at him.
4) d) At his own request
5) Not knowing how to read, the employee had given the pocketbook to his employer.
6) The villagers surrounded and questioned the old man.

SET II

1) They accused him of having the pocketbook returned by an accomplice.
2) His innocence was impossible to prove.He was stricken to the heart by the injustice of the suspicion.
3) d) Obsession
4) In the delirium of his death struggles he kept claiming his innocence, reiterating: "A piece of string, a piece of string, look – here it is, Your Honour, the Mayor."
5) C) ii and iii are correct
6) NP- His innocence VP- was impossible to prove

Discourses

I) Narrate the story 'A Piece of String' by Guy de Maupassant in your own words

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‘ A Piece of String ‘ is a touching story written by Guy de Maupassant,a renowned French writer and a master of short story. In this psychological realistic short story, the writer portrays the harsh realities of rural French life and the destructive power of gossip.

‘A Piece of String, a realistic fiction develops through the mental conflicts of the protagonist, Huachecome. He is misunderstood and wrongly judged by the society. He dies as a victim of falsely accused by his fellow beings. Hauchecome, an old peasant of Goderville found a piece of string from the public square on a crowded market day. He took it as he believed that everything useful should be picked up. It was witnessed by his enemy Malandain, the harness maker. They were on bad terms with each other. He concealed the string in his trouser’s pocket as he felt shame to be seen thus by his enemy.

While enjoying the food at the tavern, he noticed the public crier’s announcement of the lost of a pocketbook containing five hundred francs and some business papers. A reward of twenty francs was also declared. After sometime, Hauchecome was taken to the Mayor’s office by the chief of the gendarmes. There in the Mayor’s office, he was questioned by the Mayor for falsely accusing of taking the pocketbook from the market square. He was shocked when he realised that it was Malandain who raised the allegation against him. He was confronted with Malandain. The Mayor questioned him and even searched him after the request by Malandain. He tried his level best to keep his self importance and pride. The Mayor discharged him as nothing was found on him.

The people of Goderville laughed at him whenever he tried to prove his innocence. Even though the pocketbook was recovered, the people of Goderville continued their attitude against Hauchecome. For proving his innocence, the poor peasant recounted his story of adventure to everyone. People had the air of joking while they listened. They did not seem convinced. He seemed to feel that remarks were being made behind his back. His last attempt for proving his innocence served another mental agony. A person in the tavern accused him of having the pocketbook returned by an accomplice. He tried to protest, but in vain. He returned home ashamed. Next day onwards he began to recount the adventure. Each time he added new reasons, more energetic protestations, more solemn oaths. No one believed him. Towards the end of December, he took to his bed. He died in the first days of January, and even in his last breath, he tried hard to claim his innocence.

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II) <u>Character sketch of Hauchecome</u>

Hauchecome is the protagonist of the short story A Piece of String written by Guy de Maupassant. The plot of this realistic short story develops through the conflicts inside and outside of the main character. The internal conflict within the protagonist and the conflicts between him and the society are also well portrayed in the story. Hauchecome is an innocent, pride and simple peasant in the town of Goderville. He is a typical French peasant who believes that everything useful should be picked up even if it is a piece of string. His act of taking a simple piece of string ultimately leads to his death. This trivial act is misjudged by his enemy Malandain, a harness maker which destroys Hauchecome's good will among the people of Goderville. He possesses a strong sense of self importance. He is ashamed to be seen by Malandain taking the piece of string. He immediately tries to hide it. He argues before the Mayor for suspecting him for taking the pocketbook as per the lies of Malandain. He is so simple that he repeatedly tries to prove his innocence which creates suspicion in the minds of people. He always insists that he only picks up the piece of string. The allegation of the horse dealer that he hands over the pocketbook by using an accomplice makes him mentally weak. Even in his deathbed, he tries to prove his innocence. Hauchecome is deeply concerned with his good will. He is falsely accused and misjudged by the society. He is a victim of social cruelty. He recounts his adventure to everyone, but the people of Goderville don't seem to believe his words. Their rumours, gossips and mockery lead to the death of a simple peasant who gives more importance to his pride and conscience. He values his reputation and honesty more than anything.

III) <u>Hauchecome is heart broken when he is falsely accused of stealing the pocketbook. No one believes him. He couldn't control his emotions. He expresses his thoughts and feelings to his wife. Prepare a *conversation* between Hauchecome and his wife.</u>

Hauchecome : Dear, I am distressed. I can' control my feelings. I have something to share with you.

Wife : I have been noticing your change since yesterday. What is your problem? I am eager to hear from you.

Hauchecome: You know, I have a habit of picking up everything that should be useful. Yesterday I picked up a piece of string from the market square.

Wife : Pick up a piece of string from the market ! Then what happened?

Hauchecome : It was seen by Malandain, the harness maker and he brought up an allegation that I took the lost pocketbook of the Mayor.

Wife : Why did he bring up such an allegation? Did he know it would ruin a good man's good will and reputation?

Hauchecome : Yes he knew. I think that is his intention. We are not in good terms with each other.

Wife : Why didn't you complain to the Mayor? It is not good to question the morale of a good man with malice.

Hauchecome : I was falsely accused of taking the pocketbook even by the Mayor himself. He questioned me and even searched me for the pocketbook.

Wife : That's not good. We have to file a complaint against Malandain.

Hauchecome : No one believes my words. I recounted my adventure to all. No one seems to be convinced by my words.

Wife : Don't worry. I will be with you.

IV) <u>After Hauchecome dies, the Mayor appears deeply remorseful and troubled. He couldn't control his emotions. He jotted down his feelings in a diary. How the *diary entry* will be?</u>

1st February 2026

How can I overcome the weight of mind? Today morning I came to know about death of Hauchecome. They said that his last words are "A piece of string, a piece of string, look –here it is, Your Honour, the Mayor." My heart is getting heavier. I think I was responsible for the death of an innocent peasant. I can't control my emotions. I shouldn't have misunderstood a person based on some one else's words. Even in his last breath, he tried to prove his innocence. I blindly believe the words of Malandain. My preconceptions and the attitude of the society led to his miserable death. I questioned and searched him thinking that Malandain was trustworthy. Now I realised he used me as a tool to take revenge against his enemy. Even after the recovery of the pocketbook, I should have taken necessary steps to exonerate the accused from the case.

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Huachecome was misjudged and falsely accused by all. No one believed his words. Society can make or break a person. Prejudices and biased actions are not good for rulers like me.

I must write to his family. May be that will help clear up any misconceptions about me.

V) <u>In the story 'A Piece of String' the death of Hauchecome is very tragic. False accusations and societal cruelty lead to his death. Imagine that you are the reporter of a local daily and you are asked to report the death of Hauchecome. How the *news report* will be?</u>

Societal cruelty leads to the tragic end of an innocent peasant

Staff Reporter

Goderville, Jan 3: A long term resident of the village Goderville namedV Hauchecome passed away here yesterday evening. False accusations and societal cruelty led to the death of this simple, innocent and trustworthy peasant. One month before he was accused of taking a pocketbook containing five hundred francs and some business papers.

"Huachecome was falsely accused of taking the pocketbook," says his wife. His family members said that he was very much distressed these days. Hauchecome took a piece of string from the public square on a crowded market day. It was witnessed by Malandain, a harness maker. They were on bad terms with each other. On the same day, a pocketbook containing five hundred francs and some business papers was lost. Malandain misled the Mayor into thinking Hauchecome stole the pocketbook.

They questioned and searched Hauchecome. He tried his level best to prove his innocence. No one believed him.

Hauchecome died as a victim of societal cruelty and false accusations. The lost pocketbook was recovered the next day, but society continued to fall allegation against the old peasant. He died not of age, but of a broken heart due to collective misunderstanding and unable to survive public redicule.

One of witnesses reported that even in his deathbed he tried to prove his innocence. 'His last words are", says his son "A piece of string, a piece of string, look –here it is, Your Honour, the Mayor." The family has decided fight legally against the authorities.

VI) <u>After the death of Hauchecome, his family decided to file a complaint against Malandain, the Mayor and others. Prepare a *letter of complaint.*</u>

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Green Villa
Goderville

20th January 2025

To
The Chief of Judicial Police
Gendarmes Nationale
France

sub:- complaint to investigate the death of Hauchecome who died due to mob brutality regarding :

Sir,

I am sorry to have to trouble you with a complaint. I am Mrs Hauchecome, an inhabitant of Goderville. My husband Hauchecome died on the 7th January as a victim of mob brutality and being falsely accused. My husband was a simple and innocent peasant of Goderville. He believed that everything useful should be picked up. On a crowded market day he took a piece of string from the public square. He was falsely accused of taking a pocketbook containing some business papers and five hundred francs by Malandain, the harness maker who was in bad terms with my husband. Malandain misled the Mayor into thinking Hauchecome stole the pocketbook. The people of Goderville believed that he stole the pocketbook. Even though the pocketbook was recovered, they continued their accusations against him. He died broken without proving his innocence. I request you to conduct a thorough investigation into matter and take necessary steps to get justice to our family. No one should have such a plight again in our village.
I shall be obliged if you look into the matter seriously and take action.

Yours faithfully
Mrs Hauchecome

VII) <u>Prepare a profile of Guy de Maupassant by using the hints given below:</u>

Born :5 August 1850
Known as : master of short story
Nationality : French

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Pen name : Guy de Valmont

Career : novelist,poet, short story writer, comedian

Spouse : Josephine Litzelmann

Literary movement : naturalism, realism

Themes : human lives, destinies and social forces in pessimistic outlook

Major works : The Necklace, The Horla, A Piece of String

Awards : Vitet Prize,1893

Death : 6th July 1893

Guy de Maupassant

Guy de Maupassant, the famous French poet and novelist, was born on 5 August 1850. He was renowned as master of short story. He received his pen name as Guy de Valmount. He was famous as novelist, poet, short story writer and comedian. He was the greatest proponent of naturalism and realism. His spouse was Josephine Litzemann. His major works are The Necklace, The Horla and A Piece of String. Themes of his stories are human lives, destinies and social forces in pessimistic outlook. He bagged the awards like Vitet award in 1893. He passed away on 6th July 1893.

VII) Read the passage below and frame three appropriate WH-questions and one yes/ no questions:

The next day about one o'clock in the afternoon, an employee in a shop returned the pocketbook. The man claimed to have found the object in the road. Not knowing how to read, he had given it to his employer. The news spread through the neighbourhood. Hauchecome was informed of it.

Answers

1) Who retuned the pocketbook?
2) What did the employee claim?
3) Why did the employer give the pocketbook to the employer?
4) Was Hauchecome informed of the news?

Language Elements (A PIECE OF STRING)

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1. Report the following dialogue.

1. Officer : Will you accompany me to the Mayor's office?

Hauchecome : Yes, of course. I will accompany you.

2. Hauchecome : How embarrassing it is to be victimised!

Villager : Why didn't you prove your innocence?

3. Malandain: Why did you bend down just now?

Hauchecome: I bent down to pick up a piece of string, that's all.

4. Mayor: Did you take the pocketbook?

Hauchecome: No, sir. I just picked up a bit of string from the road.

5. Police Officer: Can anyone prove what you say is true?

Hauchecome: Yes, Master Malandain saw me pick up the string.

6. Villager: Why are you so worried?

Hauchecome: Because no one believes that I am innocent.

7. Villager: Have you heard that the pocketbook has been found?

Hauchecome: Yes, but people still call me a liar.

8. Mayor: Why did you stoop in the marketplace?

Hauchecome: I just picked up a little piece of string lying on the ground.

9. Villager: Did you really steal the pocketbook, Master Hauchecome?

Hauchecome: No! I swear I only picked up a bit of string.

10. Police Officer: Will you come with me to the station,

Hauchecome: Yes, but I have done nothing wrong.

11. The chief : Will you please accompany met o the Mayor's office?
Hauchecome : Yes , I am ready to accompany you.
12, Mayor : From where did you get the pocketbook?
Hauchecome : I didn't notice such a pocket book.
13. Hauchecome : Please listen to my words. The pocket book was returned.
Villager : Shut up . You are are a liar

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2.Edit the passage. Errors are given in bold.

1.Then the man **go (a)** away and the **peseants (b**) began to talk of this event. They discussed the chances of finding **and (c**) not finding the pocket book. They **are (d)** finishing their coffee **where (e**) a chief of **an (f)** gendarmes appeared.

2. Hauchecome was (a) **walking** through the marketplace when he suddenly **bend** (b) down to pick up a small piece of string. Some villagers who **was** (c) watching him **suspect** (d) that he had stolen the pocketbook. Even when the truth **are** (e) known, the people **refused** (f) to believe him.

3. Hauchecome **see** (a) a small piece of string lying on the road and **pick** (b) it up carefully. A villager who **were** (c) nearby **think** (d) that Hauchecome had taken the pocketbook. Though the pocketbook **is** (e) later found, the villagers **continue** (f) to doubt his honesty.

4. Having at last **took (a**) a seat, he politely thanked the passengers **that (b**) had helped his wife **in (c)** making room for her. Then he **turn (d)** round to the woman and politely inquired.

5. The man went up ***(a)*** and the peasants began to talk of this event. They discussed the ***chance (b)*** of finding or not finding the pocketbook. They were ***finished*****(c)** their coffee when a ***chief (d)*** of the gendarmes appeared.

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the bracket.

1.Along all the roads —(a)— Goderville, the peasants —(b)— their wives were coming —(c)— the town because it was market day. Some led a cow or a calf —(d)— a cord, and their wives, walking —(e)— the animal, whipped it with — (f)—- leafy branch to hasten its progress. (behind, to, and, around, a, by)

2.The news spread ——(a)—— the neighbourhood. Hauchecome was informed of it. He immediately began ——(b)—— recount his story ——(c)—— its happy climax. He was —— (d)—— triumph. He talked ——(e)—— his adventure all day long. He told it ——(f)—— the highway to people who were passing by. (with, to, through, on, of, in)

3. When Hauchecome reached the market place __(a)_ Goderville, he greeted the people he knew and walked slowly among the stalls. Suddenly, he saw Malandain, the harness-maker, standing _(b)__ the other side of the street, watching him closely. Hauchecome pretended not to notice and moved __(c)_ a group of farmers. After _(d)__while, news spread that a pocketbook had been lost, and Hauchecome was called _(e)__ the Mayor's office. He tried hard to convince them __(f)_ his innocence, but no one believed him. (in, to, across, on, of, a, with)

4. When Hauchecome arrived __a_ the market, he was greeted warmly _b___ a few farmers. He walked slowly __c_ the stalls, stopping now and then to talk. Suddenly, he bent down to pick up

something lying _d__ the ground. Some people laughed _e__ him, thinking he was acting miserly. Later, when a pocketbook was reported missing, suspicion quickly fell __f_ him. (on, at, along, at, upon, by)

5.Along all_(a)_ roads_(b)_ Goderville, the peasants and their wives were coming_(c)_ the town because it was market day. Some led a cow_(d)_ a calf by a cord, and their wives, walking_(e)_ the animal, whipped it_(f)_ a leafy branch to hasten its progress.

(behind, to, with , around, the, by, or)

6.The dishes were passed_(a)_ emptied,_(b)_ were the jugs_(c)_ cider. The peasants discussed _(d)_ crops, and their purchases and sales. The weather (e) favourable for the green things but not _(f)_the wheat.

(for, was, he, of, as,

.

4. Complete the paragraph using appropriate phrasal verbs given in brackets

1.The man _____ his child with great care as he rested under the tree. When the soldier came and _____ the topic of war, he tried to _____ his emotions, pretending to be calm. He said that he had _____ his son proudly to fight for the country. But as the conversation went on and the truth _____, he realized how deeply he had been hurt by the loss of his only son. The man's quiet grief showed the futility and pain that war leaves behind.

(bring up, hold up, Look after. Came out, send off, put off)

2. The man ___(a)____ to the market early in the morning, hoping to sell his piece of string. While walking, he ___(b)____ an old acquaintance who seemed to___(c)____ him for something he hadn't done. Trying not to ___(d)____ the situation, he explained everything calmly. However, the villagers soon ___(e)____ the story, and he felt deeply hurt by their mistrust. Despite everything, he continued to ___(f)____ his daily work, showing quiet resilience.

(turn up, run into, accuse of, make out, come out, carry on)

3.The man _____ the string from the ground, hoping no one had noticed. But soon, the villagers _____ him, asking suspicious questions. He tried to _____ the misunderstanding, explaining that it was just a piece of string. Yet, the rumors _____ quickly, and many people began to doubt his honesty. Despite the hurt, he decided to _____ with his daily chores, showing patience and dignity.

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(pick up, come up to, clear up, spread out, go on)

4.The man _____ early in the morning to fetch water from the well. On his way back, he accidentally _____ a piece of string and thought it was worthless. Suddenly, the mayor _____ him, questioning his actions. He tried to _____ the confusion, but the villagers soon _____ and started gossiping about him. Feeling upset, he decided to _____ quietly with his daily life.

(set out, come across, call up, sort out, get around, carry on)

5.Old Hauchecome decided to .....(a) a brave face as he entered the busy market square, determined to go about his business. He desperately wanted to .....(b) his version of the truth to anyone who would listen, but the sheer weight of public opinion was against him. When the Mayor himself accused him, Hauchecome was completely .....(c) by the severity of the official charge. He swore on his honour that he had merely picked up a piece of string, but no one believed his protestations of innocence. Though his heart was heavy, he refused to .....(d) hope that the lost pocketbook would eventually be found. The shame and the relentless mockery, however, became so overwhelming that the old peasant felt himself slowly.....(e) his struggle for reputational salvage. The misunderstanding and the subsequent scorn ultimately proved too much for him to -------(f).

(put on, giving up, taken aback, put up with, put across)

6.The next day, Hauchecome _____(a)_____ to town. There he _____(c)_____ people from villages. He _____(c)_____ with the of the adventure he had before. Most of them couldn't _____(d)_____ the story told by Hauchecome.

(Come across, set out, set down, make out, put across)

7.Hauchecome ____(a)_____ the public square on a crowded market day. There he ___(b)_____ of a little piece of string. He thought that everything useful ought to be picked up. He ___(c)_____ the piece of string which ____(d)_____ his death.

(bring about, turn up, put forward, find out, take hold of)

5. Complete the conversation

1.Complete the following conversation between the Mayor and Hauchecome:

Mayor: Hauchecome, you were seen picking up something from the road yesterday, _____(a)

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Hauchecome: Yes, sir, it was only a piece of string. _____? (b)
Mayor: Some villagers say they saw you hide it. If you had told the truth earlier, _____(c)
Hauchecome: But I didn't hide anything! Would you mind _____(d) for a moment, sir?
Mayor: You had better _____(e), Hauchecome. Getting angry won't help.
Hauchecome: How can I remain calm when everyone doubts me for such a trivial thing?
Mayor: You realize that I must investigate, don't you? It is my duty as the Mayor.

2. **Complete the conversation between the Mayor and Hauchecome:**

Mayor: Hauchecome, did you really pick up that string from the road, _____(a)
Hauchecome: Yes, sir. I found it lying there. _____? (b)
Mayor: Some villagers think you were trying to steal something. If you had explained earlier, _____(c)
Hauchecome: I didn't! Would you mind _____(d) for a moment, sir?
Mayor: You had better _____(e), Hauchecome. Losing your temper won't help.
Hauchecome: But everyone is accusing me unfairly!
Mayor: I understand, but it is my duty to ask questions, isn't it?

3.Malandain: Hauchecome, I saw you picking up something yesterday, _____(a)
Hauchecome: Yes, it was just a piece of string. _____? (b)
Malandain: Some people say you hid it. If you had been honest, _____(c)
Hauchecome: I didn't! Would you mind _____(d) for a moment?
Malandain: You had better _____(e), or people will continue to doubt you.
Hauchecome: I just want everyone to believe the truth.

4.Wife : Why have you been worrying for the last few days. You had better ___(a)_____
Hauchecome : I can't express my feelings. I lost everything.
Wife : _____(b) _____?
Hauchecome : I was falsely accused of taking a pocketbook.
Wife : If you speaks to me, _____(c)_____
Hauchecome : I know that. No one believes me.
Wife : Would you mind _____?
Hauchecome : You are right. I will file a complaint to the police.

6. Read the following passage and fill in the blanks using appropriate words from those given in the brackets.

The Sahayata Foundation is a prominent organisation dedicated to promoting social justice through education. It works to provide quality schooling for children from underprivileged backgrounds, ensuring every child's .....(a)..... to good education. Providing such children with

education is the .....(b)..... way to protect them from exploitation. By fostering an inclusive environment, the Foundation aims to .....(c)..... the issues which hinder the development of the children. Exploitation of all .....(d)..... has to be prevented.

(address, right, kind/kinds)

ANSWERS

1. **Report the following dialogue.**

1.The officer asked Hauchecome if he would accompany him to the Mayor's office.
Hauchecome replied that he would accompany him.

2.Hauchecome exclaimed that it was very embarrassing to be victimised.
The villager asked him why he had not proved his innocence.

3.Malandain asked Hauchecome why he had bent down just then.
Hauchecome replied that he had bent down to pick up a piece of string and nothing else.

4.The Mayor asked Hauchecome if he had taken the pocketbook.
Hauchecome replied respectfully that he had not taken it and that he had only picked up a bit of string from the road.

5.The police officer asked whether anyone could prove what Hauchecome said was true.
Hauchecome replied that Master Malandain had seen him pick up the string.

6.The villager asked Hauchecome why he was so worried.
Hauchecome replied that he was worried because no one believed that he was innocent.

7.The villager asked Hauchecome if he had heard that the pocketbook had been found.
Hauchecome replied that he had heard it, but people still called him a liar.

8.The Mayor asked Hauchecome why he had stooped in the marketplace.
Hauchecome replied that he had only picked up a small piece of string lying on the ground.

9.The villager asked Master Hauchecome whether he had really stolen the pocketbook.
Hauchecome swore that he had not stolen it and said that he had only picked up a bit of string.

10. The police officer asked Hauchecome if he would come with him to the station.
Hauchecome replied that he would come, but added that he had done nothing wrong.

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11 The chief asked Hauchecome if he would accompany him to the Mayor's office.
Hauchecome replied positively that he was ready to accompany him.
12.Mayor asked Hauchecome from where he had got the pocketbook.
Hauchecome replied that he hadn't noticed such a pocketbook
13. Hauchecome requested the villager to listen to his words. He added that the pocketbook had been returned
The villager ordered him to shut up and he added that he was a liar.

2.Edit the passage.

1.(a) went
(b) peasants
(c) or
(d) were
(e) when
(f) the

2. (a) was walking
(b) bent
(c) were
(d) suspected
(e) was
(f) refused to believe him

3. (a) saw
(b) picked
(c) was
(d) thought
(e) was
(f) continued

4. (a) taken
(b) who
(c) making
(d) turned

5, a) away
b) chances
c) finishing
d) chief

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3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the bracket.

1.(a) around
(b) and
(c) to
(d) by
(e) behind
(f) a

2. (a) through
(b) to
(c) to
(d) in
(e) of
(f) on

3. (a) in
(b) on
(c) to
(d) a
(e) to
(f) of

4) (a) at
(b) by
(c) along
(d) on
(e) at
(f) upon

5.a)the b)around c) to d) the e)was f) for

6,a) and b)as c)of d) e)was f)for

4. Complete the paragraph using appropriate phrasal verbs given in brackets

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1.(a) looked after
(b) brought up
(c) hold up
(d) sent off
(e) came out

2. (a) turned up
(b) ran into
(c) accuse of
(d) make out
(e) came out
(f) carry on

3) (a) picked up
(b) came up to
(c) clear up
(d) spread out
(e) go on

4. (a) set out
(b) came across
(c) called up
(d) sort out
(e) get around
(f) carry on

5. (a) put on
(b) put across
(c) taken aback
(d) give up
(e) giving up
(f) put up with

6.a) set out b) came across c) put across d) make out
7.a) turned up b) found out c) took hold of d) brought about

5.complete the conversation

1. (a) didn't you?
(b) What do you think about that
(c) things would have been much simpler

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(d) listening
(e) stay calm

2. (a) didn't you?
(b) How can I prove it
(c) no one would have doubted you
(d) listening
(e) remain calm

3. (a) didn't you?
(b) How can I prove it
(c) no one would have doubted you
(d) listening
(e) stay calm

4.a) speak everything to me.
b) What happened.
c) it will reduce your sorrow
d) filing a complaint to the police

6, **Read the following passage and fill in the blanks using appropriate words from those given in the brackets.**

a) right b) right c) address d) kinds

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